The Parishioner

Sunday 11-October-2026



Twenty Eighth Sunday In Ordinary Time
Prisioner's Sunday
od promised his people a future of great blessings where death and mourning would be no more. Christ came to issue God's *final invitation to this future. Some rejected it, others accepted it but then made light of it. What have we done with our invitation?*



The Family of Parishes of: Ballincollig | Ballinora | Kilmurry | Ovens and Farran

Vocations for The Diocese of Cork

Last weekend, we had the visit of the Director of Vocations to the parish of Ballincollig. Father Marius O'Reilly was appointed a few weeks ago to this role in a full-time capacity. Part of his ministry initially will be to visit the sixty-eight parishes across the diocese of Cork and Ross. So, I'm sure he'll make it to the folks in Ballinora, Ovens, and Kilmurry in the coming months also. Beyond telling us a little about his own vocation story and narrating the appointments he's held since being ordained, Marius also reached out for people to form a monthly prayer meeting specifically for vocations to the priesthood in the diocese of Cork and Ross. Some 56 people signed up in Ballincollig, which I think is quite encouraging. The Church does need some of its members to serve communities as ordained priests and praying for this is worthwhile, not least because it reminds us to be open to God's will in our lives.

That said, though, I do wonder about the bigger picture. If a lack of vocations were down to a lack of prayer, then the issue would never have arisen: each and every day people tell me that they pray for their priests and for vocations. So, a reasonable person would naturally be led to ask if the Holy Spirit is prompting us to change how we are as a Church. And while no one person can speak definitively for the Spirit, the 'sensus fidelium' ['the shared sense of the faithful'] is worth paying heed to. I know myself that hardly a week goes by without someone asking me about the potential role of married men and women. These are legitimate questions to ask, even if a convincing answer comes frustratingly slowly.

In the meantime, it might be good to ask ourselves what role I can exercise in my local parish: what gifts do I have to share? There is ever and always a need for additional voices to read, more hands to minister Holy Communion, new minds to share vision at the Parish Pastoral Council. All that's asked is that we be open to God's will in our lives – both in what's necessary now, and what's possible in the future.

God bless.

Ronan Sheehan CC

Abide in His Love Women's Conference

Abide Women's Conference, November 20-22, the Great Northern Hotel Bundoran, Co. Donegal. Speakers include: Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Domincans & more, Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, from Cork & Ross Diocese. We would love to welcome you this weekend. For more details please visit Abide in His Love at eventbrite.ie Registration link: https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com

Irish National Synodal Assembly

The Working Document for the Irish National Synodal Assembly, taking place in Gormanston, Co Meath, on 17 October, brings together the fruits of five years of prayer, listening and discernment and will guide delegates as they consider and vote on suggested actions to be presented to the bishops of Ireland. While the Assembly marks an important moment in the journey, the Synodal Pathway is now moving towards a new phase of implementation. Everyone is invited to read, pray with, and reflect on the Working Document and the question: "What does God want from the Church in Ireland at this time?" Please pray for all those taking part in the Assembly and for the guidance of the Holy Spirit. To find out more, see www.synod.ie

October - The Month of the Holy Rosary

"Pope Leo has asked us to pray the Rosary for Peace during the Month of October" (CNS/Vatican Media). St. Mary's & St. John's Church Ballincollig 7-8 PM. All are invited to join in prayer for peace just for a short while, or for one Rosary or for the Hour of Prayer.

7:00: Joyful Mysteries - Silence
7:15: Sorrowful Mysteries - Silence
7:30: Glorious Mysteries - Silence
7:45 Mysteries of Light

It is giving people an opportunity to join for whatever time you can manage, or bring your children for a short time.

Notification of second collection at all Masses for dates specified below

Diocesan needs 10th / 1th October, Propagation of the Faith 17th / 18th October Diocesan Youth Ministry 14th/ 15th November

Applies to all churches in Family of Parishes

In the Lord's own house shall I dwell for ever and ever.

Ballincollig Parish Number for Priest on Duty is: 087 4021357
For Parish office Telephone is 089 4008181 Mon - Wed. 9.00am - 12.30pm

Visit Our Website: theparishioner.ie or Facebook www.facebook.com/ BallincolligParish

Scan for Website

† IN SYMPATHY †

PLEASE PRAY FOR THE FAMILY AND FRIENDS OF THE RECENTLY DECEASED :

Peter Duffy, Willow Drive & Monaghan.
Philip Rowell, Beech Park.
Mary O'Keeffe, Ballinhassig/ Powdermills Nursing Home.

PLEASE PRAY FOR THE REPOSE OF THE SOULS OF THE FOLLOWING WHOSE ANNIVERSARY OCCURS OR OTHERWISE REMEMBERED:

John & Mabel Garrett, Ballincollig.
Carmel Kelly, The Crescent.
Oliver O'Donovan, Beech Park.
Fr Paul O'Donoghue.
May Fortuin, Cathedral Rd.
Michael Healy, Cloghroe.
Maureen Kelly, Newcestown.
Dr Timothy O'Connell, Ballingulley & Ballinhassig.
Mary O'Sullivan, Glenleigh, Kilcorney.
Marjorie Kinsella, Ballyshoneen.
Ann Kidney, Greenfields.
Elizabeth Barrett, Coolroe.
Margaret, David, Frank & Martin Muldoon.
Joe Guerin & his parents Hannah & Tade, Knocknagree.

Formation in Faith for Young Adults

The Diocese of Cork and Ross, in collaboration with UCC Chaplaincy and the Presentation Brothers LEAF Project, is delighted to offer a Formation in Faith programme for young adults (18–35 years). The programme begins on Wednesday, 30 September 2026, and will run for 9 weeks, from 5.45–8.00pm in Mardyke House, Cork (T12 W8RP). Participants can choose between two concurrent pathways:

a) Sycamore Formation Series: A video-based programme with guided group discussion on Catholic formation.
b) Foundations in Theology: A lecture-based introduction to Catholic theology.
c) Each session begins with food and refreshments, and provide participants with an opportunity to engage in meaningful discussion.

To sign-up or for more information, email Sheila at youthministry@corkandross.org

Discovery

A faith study as part of the Cork and Ross Diocese faith development. Through Discovery you can deepen your daily life with God and learn a new awareness of just who you are, and how you can live. As the Evangelist John says in 10;10; 'have life and have it all in its fullness'. The Catholic belief is that God knows us and loves us - that we have been loved into being, that love is holding us and that love is calling us to be one with God for eternity. 1 hour per week for 6 weeks. 2 small groups of 6 participants each. Wednesday (Men) Thursdays (Women). For the people in the family of parishes of Ballincollig, Ballinora, Oven/ Farran, and Kilmurry. Initial Contact Fr. Alan O'Leary PP, Ballincollig or any priest in the family of parishes.

Prisoners' Sunday

Prisoners' Sunday in Ireland and the Catholic Church will be observed on today Sunday, 11 October 2026.
This annual national day of prayer and action focuses on supporting prisoners, their children, and families, as well as reflecting on the social and living conditions within the penal system.

READINGS FOR THE WEEK

Twenty Eighth Week In Ordinary Time

11 Sunday Is. 25:6-10. Phil. 4: 12-14, 19-20. Mt. 22: 1.14. Lect I: 711

12 Monday Gal 4:22-24, 26-27, 31-5:1. Ps 112. Lk 11:29-32. Lect II: 814

13 Tuesday Gal 5:1-6. Ps 118. Lk 11:37-41. Lect II: 816

14 Wednesday Gal. 5:18-25. Ps. 1. Lk. 11 :42-46. Lect II: 817

15 Thursday Eph 1:1-10. Ps 97. Lk 11:47-54. Lect II: 819

16 Friday Eph 1:11-14. Ps 32. Lk 12:1-7. Lect II: 822

17 Saturday Eph. 1: 15-23. Ps. 8. Lk. 12:8-12. Lect II: 824

Next Sunday's Readings 18-October-2026
Is 45:1, 4-6. Ps 95:1, 3-5, 7-10, R/ v 7. 1 Th 1:1-5. Mt 22:15-21. Lect I:714

Ballincollig Mass Times

St. Mary & St. John		Christ Our Light
8:30 am, 10 am	Sunday	11 am, 12:30 pm
9:30 am	Monday	No Morning Mass
9:30 am	Tuesday	No Morning Mass
9:30 am	Wednesday	8:30 am
9:30 am	Thursday	8:30 am
9:30 am	Friday	8:30 am
6:00 pm (Vigil)	Saturday	7:30 pm (Vigil)

Ballincollig Bulletin Board

Coeliac Hosts

Low gluten hosts are available and suitable for Coeliac's Please inform the priest prior to Mass if possible if you require it.

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament

There will be Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament at 3p.m. until 4p.m. in St. Mary & St. John's Church every Friday.

Meditation

Meditation continues in the Ballincollig Community Hall on Tuesday morning after 9.30am Mass. New members welcome.

Cemetery Masses and The Blessing of The Graves

Mass in St. Oliver's Cemetery Sat. November 7th at 2pm.
Mass in St. Mary & St. John's Cemetery Sat. 31st October at 12 noon.

The Irish Cancer Society

is seeking compassionate volunteer drivers to join our pool of drivers. As a volunteer driver you would be bringing patients undergoing chemotherapy to the hospital and back home for their treatment. Gifting your time means that cancer patients will have comfortable (one on one) transport to attend appointments for their lifesaving treatment. If you can spare 2 days per month, have a valid driving licence, and a safe, reliable vehicle, you are the perfect candidate to make a significant difference. The Irish Cancer Society will provide you with training before you start as a driver for us. Your generosity not only eases the journey for many during a challenging time but also offers comfort and support when it's needed most. For more information and to become a volunteer driver, please contact Monica or Emily at volunteer@irishcancer.ie